



GIMP for Beginners, Part 4

The Selection Wand

Welcome to the fourth instalment of tutorials on the GIMP. This is where we start learning about the many techniques and exquisite effects that can be created using this application. In this tutorial, we focus on the selection and gradient tools.

After all the banter about the various tools available, it's time to get our hands dirty with the GIMP. Last month, we discovered various aspects of image editing, along with the interface and layers. But from now on, we will explore new effects, cool techniques and other ways to create exquisite effects. In this tutorial, we will start by creating a very simple wallpaper using just the primary selection and gradient tool.

Before we get started, it is important to know the size of the image we want to create/edit. So if you wish to start creating an image, I would recommend choosing your monitor resolution. Using the same resolution will produce the best effects and you will not need to resize the image, in case you wish to use it as your wallpaper.

Step 1 Fire up the GIMP and click on *File→New*. Set the resolution to that of your desktop. I will be using a resolution of 1920 x 1200 so that those with very high-end monitors can use the wallpaper without any distortion.

Once you have created a new image, notice the white worksheet in the Gimp workspace. (*Ed's note:* You can select the colour of the background and can also make it transparent, if you want.) This is the base for the wallpaper. (See Figure 1.)

Step 2 Now, click on the 'Create new layer' icon to create a transparent layer. Change the layer's name by double-clicking on it or by right-clicking→*Edit Layer Attributes*. Set the new name as *Base*.

